

Design by area: guide for the 60-minute segment

OBJECTIVE • 9:45 TO 10:45

Leave with a future-state sketch for each area and the gaps that block it.

TIME BOX

60 min

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- **Open:** Which step costs a patient the most time today?
- **Probe:** Where does the work wait, and who is it waiting on?
- **Probe:** What do you do when the system says no?
- **Probe:** Which step would you remove first, and what breaks?
- **Probe:** Who outside this room feels this change?
- **Probe:** How often does this happen, and how do we know?
- **Test:** If we did only this, would you stand behind it on Monday?

LISTEN FOR

- Workarounds nobody wrote down
- Handoffs with no owner
- Quick win: one fix, one owner, 30 days
- Disagreement between areas

SCRIBE CAPTURES

- Decisions, owners, open questions
- Pain points in their own words

WATCH-OUTS

- One voice filling the time
- Solutions before the pain is clear
- Drift into another area
- Quiet tables never heard

OUTPUT AT 10:45

- One canvas for each area
- A ranked list of gaps

Question bank by focus area

	QUESTION TO ASK	WHY WE ASK	LISTEN FOR
SCHEDULING	Where does a patient wait after asking for an appointment?	Maps the real path, not the policy	Workarounds, second-team calls
	Where do clinic templates differ, and why?	Finds variation with no clinical reason	“We always did it this way”
	How long before a no-show slot is refilled?	Sizes the capacity leak	Manual lists, no owner
REGISTRATION	What do you ask patients that we already know?	Surfaces repeated data capture	Re-keying, duplicate forms
	When is insurance verified, and by whom?	Locates the earliest point of catch	Day-of checks, handoffs
	Which consent is missed most often?	Finds compliance exposure	Paper scans, unclear owner
ESTIMATES	How does a patient get a price today?	Tests whether estimates exist at all	Phone calls, spreadsheets
	Which services can you quote reliably?	Picks a safe starting scope	Bundled, high-volume visits
	What do patients do when the price is high?	Links price to abandonment	Cancellations, payment-plan asks
DENIALS	Which denial codes recur every week?	Finds the few causes behind the volume	Eligibility, authorization
	Which denials start at the front desk?	Separates front-end from billing causes	Missing data, wrong plan
	Who sees a denial, and how fast?	Tests the feedback loop to the source	Weeks of delay, no feedback

Question ladder for the estimates topic

TOPIC _____

- Estimates: a price patients can rely on before they book.

IF THE ANSWER IS VAGUE _____

- “Give me one example from this week.”
- “What would a new hire see on day one?”
- “How many times a month is that?”
- “Who would answer that differently?”

RULE OF THUMB _____

- No challenge until the story is told.

Open RUNG 1

“Walk me through the last time a patient asked what a visit would cost.” Intent: get the real story, not the policy. Move on when you hear a named step.

Probe RUNG 2

“What happened next, and who did you hand it to?” Intent: trace handoffs and waiting time. Move on when each wait has an owner.

Challenge RUNG 3

“If the estimate came before booking, what would break?” Intent: test assumptions and find the true constraint. Move on when the constraint is named.

Confirm RUNG 4

“So the blocker is missing charge data. Is that right, and who owns it?” Intent: check we heard it and agree an owner. Move on when the table says yes.

SIGNS THE LADDER IS WORKING

- The table names steps, owners and numbers, not opinions
- Quiet participants are speaking by rung 3
- Disagreement is stated out loud, not smoothed over

Who does what in each segment of workshop 2

SEGMENT	TIME	WHO LEADS	WHO CAPTURES	TIME AND TECH	HANDOFF CUE
Room setup	8:15	Co-lead: tables, journey map, timer	Scribe: canvases labeled, notes template open	Producer: video room, audio and screen check	Co-lead tells lead: room is ready
Welcome and goals	9:00	Lead: objectives, ground rules, parking lot	Scribe: attendee list, parking lot started	Producer: timer on screen, mute rules	Lead: “Over to the recap”
Current-state recap	9:15	Lead: journey-map walk-through, dot vote	Scribe: top five pain points	Producer: shares map, runs the vote	Lead hands tables to area leads
Design by area	9:45	Area leads: one table each, 15-minute boxes	Scribe: decisions and gaps per canvas	Producer: 10 and 2 minute warnings	Producer: break at 10:45
Break	10:45	Co-lead: reset tables, check pace	Scribe: consolidate notes, flag gaps	Producer: restart video, reopen the room	Co-lead: back at 11:00
Playback and gaps	11:00	Co-lead: five minutes per table	Scribe: gap callouts on the board	Producer: strict five-minute timer	Co-lead hands to lead at 11:35
Decisions and next steps	11:40	Lead: fist-to-five, owners and dates	Scribe: decisions log read back	Producer: shares the log live	Lead: “Read back the log”
Close and debrief	12:00	Lead: pre-work, one-word check-out	Scribe: send notes within 24 hours	Producer: stops recording, saves files	Team debrief at 12:15

Listen for the signal, watch for the flag

SESSION OBJECTIVE

Design the future state for
scheduling, registration, estimates
and denials.

GROUND RULES

- Timeboxes hold; the parking lot takes the rest
- Every decision gets an owner and a date
- Problems before solutions
- Every table speaks at playback
- Video tables get equal airtime

	IF YOU HEAR	THEN ASK
SIGNALS	“We work around it.”	“Show me the workaround. What does it cost?”
	“That depends on the clinic.”	“Which clinics differ, and is there a reason?”
	“One person always fixes it.”	“What happens when they are away?”
RED FLAGS	“We need a new system.”	“What does the process need first?”
	“That is not our problem.”	“Who owns it, and are they here?”
	Silence or quick agreement	“What would make this fail?”
	One voice answering for all	“Let us hear from the other tables.”

If this happens, do this: contingencies for workshop 2

SEVERITY	IF THIS HAPPENS	EARLY SIGN	DO THIS	OWNER
P1	Decision-makers missing	Sponsor or area lead absent at 9:15	Mark decisions as recommendations; log an owner and a date; confirm by email within 24 hours.	Lead
P1	Video fails for remote table	No audio or picture for two minutes	Producer moves them to the phone bridge and shares a photo of the canvas; the scribe pastes notes live.	Producer
P2	Running long	Ten minutes behind at the break	Cut in this order: 1 playback to three minutes a table; 2 recap dot vote; 3 gap discussion, moved to follow-up. Never cut decisions.	Lead
P2	Dominant voice	One person holds over 40% of airtime	Round-robin on index cards; “Let us hear from tables not yet in”; side-chat at the break.	Area lead
P3	Off-topic deep dive	Five minutes on one system	Park it with an owner, offer a follow-up session, and return to the canvas.	Area lead
P3	Low energy	Quiet tables after the break	Stand-up pair share, switch to sticky notes, shorten the next timebox.	Co-lead

Breakout table guide: one prompt per focus area

TABLE 1 • SCHEDULING

- **Prompt:** Draw one front door and one template for every service line.
- **Materials:** Canvas, template samples
- **Time:** 20 min · 2-minute report-back: three steps, one gap

ASK THIS TABLE _____

- Where does a request wait today?
- Which template could every clinic use?
- Who owns the no-show list?

TABLE 2 • REGISTRATION

- **Prompt:** Capture insurance and consent once, before the patient arrives.
- **Materials:** Canvas, form samples
- **Time:** 20 min · 2-minute report-back: data captured, owner

ASK THIS TABLE _____

- What do we ask that we already know?
- Who verifies, and when?
- Which consent is missed most?

TABLE 3 • ESTIMATES

- **Prompt:** Give a price a patient can rely on before they book.
- **Materials:** Canvas, price list sample
- **Time:** 20 min · 2-minute report-back: services quoted first

ASK THIS TABLE _____

- Which ten services first?
- What data is missing today?
- What happens when the price is high?

TABLE 4 • DENIALS

- **Prompt:** Stop front-end causes of denial before the claim is sent.
- **Materials:** Canvas, top denial codes
- **Time:** 20 min · 2-minute report-back: top three causes

ASK THIS TABLE _____

- Which codes recur weekly?
- Which start at the front desk?
- How fast does feedback return?